

What is puberty?

During puberty, males reach physical maturity and become capable of sexual reproduction. With emotional and physical changes all happening at once, puberty can be a challenging time for teens.

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GOOD TO KNOW

Body confidence

It's normal to feel self-conscious or embarrassed about your body during puberty. Try not to worry—it's a natural process that everyone goes through, and it can be fun.

What to expect

On average, males start puberty a year later than females, normally between the ages of 9 and 14. During puberty, with so many changes happening, it's not unusual for tweens and teens to feel as if their body and emotions are out of control. In order for teens to feel better prepared for puberty, it helps to learn about how the body works and what to expect.

Body hair

Thicker, darker, and coarser hair starts growing in the pubic region and on the legs and chest. By the end of puberty, this hair becomes curly.



Sweat and smells

A teen's body starts to produce more sweat, which can cause body odor and smelly feet.



More testosterone

Increased testosterone makes males stronger, but can influence mood and disturb sleep patterns.

Involuntary erections

Erections—a stiffening of the penis—start to occur. They can happen during sleep, throughout the day, or when a person sees someone they fancy.



Bigger genitals

Over the course of puberty, the penis lengthens, and the testicles grow larger.